Resume Analyzer

Team User Guide

A practical guide for checking resume structure, ATS readiness, measurable impact, and alignment with a target job description.

Feature	Details
Access	Sign in to Prep Buddy, then open Resume from the top navigation.
Supported files	PDF, TXT, and Markdown (.md).
Analysis mode	Runs in the browser using extracted or pasted resume text.
Persistence	The latest analysis is kept in the browser session until the user starts over.

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1. What the Resume Analyzer does

The Resume Analyzer provides a quick, rule-based review of a resume. It identifies common resume sections, checks for contact information, estimates readable length, counts action-led lines and impact signals, and optionally compares resume text with keywords from a target job description.

It is a guidance tool, not a hiring decision system. Users should review the suggestions and apply their own judgment before sending a resume to an employer.

2. How to use it

1. **Sign in:** Log in to Prep Buddy with a valid account.
2. **Open the feature:** Select **Resume** in the top navigation, or open the Resume Analyzer route.
3. **Add the resume:** Upload a PDF, TXT, or Markdown file, or paste the resume text into the text box.
4. **Wait for PDF extraction:** When a PDF is selected, the interface reads selectable text in the browser. The Analyze button remains disabled while extraction is running.
5. **Add a target role (optional):** Paste a job description to receive matched and missing keyword recommendations.
6. **Run the analysis:** Select **Analyze my resume**. The report opens on the results page.
7. **Iterate:** Review the findings, improve the resume, and choose **Analyze another resume** to start again.

3. Understanding the results

Report area	What it means
ATS readiness score	A 0?100 heuristic score based on detected sections, matched role keywords, measurable-result signals, and v
Recruiter checklist	Checks contact information, readable length, action-led bullets, measurable impact, and target-role alignment
Impact signals	Shows how many resume lines begin with recognized action verbs and how many contain numbers, percenta
What is wrong	Lists detected weaknesses that may reduce clarity or searchable evidence.
What to change	Suggests concrete revisions such as adding a summary or rewriting bullets as action plus result.
What to add	Suggests missing sections, projects, skills, certifications, or links.
Strengths and improvements	Summarizes positive signals and the highest-value areas to polish.

4. Best practices for better results

- Use a text-based PDF. Scanned or image-only PDFs cannot be reliably analyzed because they do not contain selectable text.
- Use standard headings such as Summary, Experience, Education, Skills, Projects, and Certifications.
- Write experience bullets with an action and an outcome, for example: ?Automated deployment checks, reducing release time by 30%.?
- Include numbers, percentages, scale, time saved, revenue, users, or other measurable outcomes where appropriate.
- Paste the complete target job description when tailoring for a specific role. The analyzer checks up to 18 distinct keywords after filtering common words.
- Keep the resume focused and readable. The checklist treats 120?900 words as the readable-length range.

5. Supported inputs and limitations

- **Supported:** .pdf, .txt, and .md files; pasted plain text.
- **Not supported:** .doc and .docx uploads. The interface intentionally asks users to paste text or convert the document to PDF, TXT, or Markdown.
- **Scanned PDFs:** Image-only or scanned PDFs may return no text. Use OCR elsewhere or paste the resume text manually.
- **Language:** The section and action-verb rules are primarily English-language rules.
- **Keyword matching:** Matching is text-based and case-insensitive; it does not understand synonyms or context like a human reviewer.
- **Privacy:** Resume extraction and analysis occur in the browser. The current analyzer does not upload resume content to a backend service. The result is stored in browser session storage for the current session.

6. Troubleshooting

Problem	Recommended action
The PDF says it cannot be read.	Confirm the PDF contains selectable text. Export it again from the original document or paste the text mar
The Analyze button is disabled.	Add resume text and wait until PDF reading finishes.
The report redirects back to the upload page.	The browser session may not contain a valid analysis. Analyze the resume again.
The result looks too low or too high.	Treat the score as a heuristic. Check the detailed checklist and recommendations instead of relying on the
The page is not available.	Confirm the user is signed in and that the deployed frontend includes the Resume Analyzer feature branch

7. Team handoff and production checklist

- Deploy the frontend build containing the Resume Analyzer route, navigation entry, styling, and PDF.js dependency.

- Run the production build before release: **npm run build**.
- Verify a signed-in user can open Resume, upload a text-based PDF, see extracted text, run analysis, refresh the results page, and start over.
- Verify TXT and Markdown uploads, invalid-file messaging, and scanned-PDF messaging.
- Do not add the backend server file solely for this feature; the analyzer is implemented on the frontend and does not require a new backend endpoint.

For implementation details, see the Resume Analyzer source file and the feature branch that contains the frontend route and PDF.js dependency.